Ogust

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Ogust is a conventional 2NT response to a weak two bid or weak jump overcall. It is an artificial strong bid, showing 15+ points with interest in game. It usually (but not always) shows trump support.

Ogust is a forcing bid for one round. After hearing a Ogust 2NT response, the preemptor's conventional rebids are:

Bid	Meaning
3♣	Bad hand (5-7 points) with only one of the top three honors in the preempt suit
3♦	Bad hand (5-7 points), two of the top three honors
3♥	Good hand (8-10 points), one of the top three honors
3♠	Good hand (8-10 points), two of the top three honors
3NT	Good hand (8-10 points), all three top honors

The mnemonic for remembering Ogust responses is "Minors are Minimum, 1-2-1-2-3."

Rebids by the Ogust bidder are natural.

Examples

Opener	Responder
♠Q52	♠AJ
♥AT9832	♥K65
♦T83	♦J54
♣5	♣AQ987

Opener	Responder
2♥ (1)	2NT (2)
3♣ (3)	3♥ (4)
Pass	

1. Weak two
2. Ogust, asking opener to describe her hand
3. Showing minimum strength with only 1 top honor
4. Responder signs off with a minimum game try

Opener	Responder
♠AQJ842	♠K65

♥Q4	♥AJT2
♦53	♦A742
♣762	♣A8

Opener	Responder
2♠ (1)	2NT (2)
3♠ (3)	4♠
Pass	

1. Weak two
2. Ogust
3. Showing maximum strength with 2 top honors

In Competition

If the Ogust 2NT is doubled, the above conventional rebids by opener are still on. After an overcall, however, they are off. So, after an overcall, the preempter can either double for penalties, pass with a bad hand, or rebid his suit if it's worth it.

Origins

Ogust is named for its American inventor, Harold Ogust.

See also

- Raise Only Non Forcing
  The practice of raising a weak two bid as a preemptive, non-forcing bid.
- Rule of 2, 3 and 4
  A guideline for opening a weak two bid.
- Weak Jump Overcalls
  Preemptive jump overcalls designed to obstruct the opponents' bidding.
- Weak Two Bids
  Opening bids of 2♦/♥/♠ to show a 6-card suit with a weak hand.